

Batch Production & Traceability

How every tub we make is tied to the customer who received it

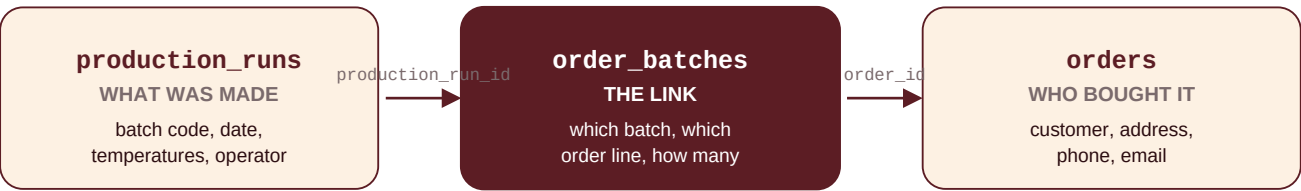
This document describes the records Creamy Bite keeps for each production batch, how those records are linked to customer orders, and how we answer the two questions an incident turns on: **“this batch is affected — who has it?”** and **“this customer is complaining — what did they get?”**

It is written to support Article 18 of assimilated Regulation (EC) No 178/2002, which requires a food business to identify the businesses and persons it has supplied. Everything described here is in daily use in our admin system, not a proposal. Section 9 sets out the limits of the system honestly, including what depends on staff doing something rather than on the software.

Business	Creamy Bite — manufacture of ice cream and frozen desserts
Premises	Unit E5 Phoenix Business Centre, Rosslyn Cres, Harrow, HA1 2SP
Contact	+44 7497 779997 · orders@creamybite.com
Supplies	Retail customers (delivery and collection) and wholesale trade accounts
Document date	19 September 2026

1 How the records fit together

Three records carry the trace. Two of them would exist in any shop — what we made, and who bought something. Neither on its own can answer a recall. The third exists purely to join them, and it is the one an inspector should look at first.



Neither end alone can answer a recall. The middle record is what makes it answerable.

Record	What it holds	Kept when
production_runs	One row per batch made: batch code, date, times, quantities, temperatures, operator, and anything that went wrong on the run.	At the time of production
order_batches	One row per batch supplied against one line of one order, with the quantity from that batch. This is the traceability link.	When the order is picked or despatched
orders	The customer: name, delivery address, postcode, telephone, email, and whether they are a retail or trade customer.	When the order is placed

2 How a batch is identified

Every batch carries two codes. Both are searchable, and a search on either returns the same batch.

Code	Example	Format	Where it is seen
Internal batch	PR-260818-01	PR- then the date as YYMMDD, then a run number counting up within that day	Our production records and admin screens
External batch	AD26081801	Two letters from the flavour name, then the date as YYMMDD, then the run number	Printed on the tub — this is the code a customer or an officer will quote

The date is carried in the code itself, so a batch code read off a tub tells you when it was made without anyone looking it up. The internal code is unique and enforced as such by the database. The external code is generated for the operator but remains editable, because a code already printed on a tub takes precedence over anything the system suggests.

3 What is recorded for each batch

These fields are captured on the production record for every run:

Group	Recorded
Identity	Batch code · external batch code · product and size · status (planned, in progress, completed, on hold, scrapped)
Timing	Date produced · time started · time finished · best-before date
Quantities	Planned quantity · actual output · rejected quantity · unit (tubs, litres)
Process control	Mix temperature (°C) · pasteurisation temperature (°C) · pasteurisation time (minutes)
People	Operator who ran the batch · the admin user who created and last amended the record, with timestamps
Narrative	Materials used · changes made during the run · problems encountered · free-text notes

A completed run can be added to sellable stock from the production record, which is how a batch becomes available to sell. The system refuses to do this until the run is marked completed and has a real output figure, so stock cannot appear from a batch that was never finished.

4 Linking a batch to an order

When an order is picked, each line is linked to the batch or batches that supplied it, with the quantity taken from each. This is the step that makes everything else possible.

A single order line may draw on more than one batch. A case of twelve can be made up from the end of Monday's run and the start of Tuesday's, so a line carries as many batch links as it needs, each with its own quantity. Assuming one batch per line would put customers on a recall list who never received the batch, and leave off customers who did.

Status shown	Meaning	Action
Traced	Batch quantities match the quantity sold on that line	None — the line is complete
Partial	Some of the line is linked, some is not	Assign the remainder
Not traced	No batch has been linked to that line	Assign before despatch
Over	More has been linked than was sold	Correct the quantities

The status is calculated, not typed, and is visible against every order line. An order is only fully traced when every line reads Traced. The same batch cannot be linked to the same order line twice — the database prevents it — so quantities cannot be double-counted.

5 Forward trace — “who has this batch?”

This is the output for a withdrawal or recall, and the one we would hand to an officer. Entering a batch code — **either** the internal code or the code printed on the tub — returns every customer who received that batch:

The recall list contains, for each customer

Order reference and the date the order was placed

Customer name, delivery address and postcode

Telephone number and email address — so the list can be worked through directly

The quantity of the affected batch that customer received

Whether they are a retail customer or a wholesale trade account, and the business name if trade

The production date, best-before date and operator for that batch

Retail and trade are separated on screen, because the two are handled differently: a wholesale customer must be told to pull stock from their own shelves and may have supplied it onward, while a retail customer must be told not to eat it. The list can be exported to CSV for emailing to an officer or working through as a call sheet.

6 Backward trace — “what did this customer get?”

The mirror of the above, used when a customer complains. Opening an order shows every batch that supplied it and, for each batch: the production date, the best-before date, the operator, the mix and pasteurisation temperatures and time, the materials used, and any problems recorded on that run. A complaint can therefore be answered against the actual conditions of the batch rather than from memory.

7 Worked example

Step	What happens	Record created
1. Production	A batch of Almond Delight 500 ml is made on 18 August. Temperatures, times, output and operator are recorded and the run is marked completed.	PR-260818-01 AD26081801
2. Stock	The completed run is added to stock, making those tubs available to sell.	Stock increased
3. Order	A trade customer orders 12 tubs. Their name, business, address, postcode, phone and email are on the order.	Order CB-1043
4. Picking	8 tubs come from AD26081801 and 4 from the previous day's batch. Both are linked to that order line with their quantities. The line reads Traced .	2 batch links
5. Incident	A problem is identified with AD26081801. The batch code is entered on the recall screen.	—
6. Recall	Every customer holding that batch is listed with contact details and quantity, trade separated from retail, ready to call and to export.	Recall list / CSV

8 Supporting records

Held in the same system and available at inspection:

Record	Contents
Documents & SOPs	Filed under Food Safety (HACCP, temperature control, cleaning, pest control), Allergens, Production, Warehouse, Delivery, Suppliers, Staff and Compliance. Each document carries a review date and overdue reviews are flagged.
Allergen information	Recorded per product against the 14 declarable allergens, with a record of whether the allergen list has been formally signed off and when. Products not yet signed off are shown as unreviewed rather than as having none.
Product specifications	Per product, for supply to trade customers and for labelling.
Delivery notes	Produced per order for despatch.

9 Limits of the system

Stated plainly, because a system description that claims more than it does is worth less than one that is candid about where the controls actually sit.

Limit	How it is managed
Linking a batch to an order is a manual step. The software records and checks the link, and shows any line that is incomplete, but it does not create the link by itself.	Every order line shows its trace status, so an untraced line is visible before despatch rather than discovered during an incident.
Incoming ingredient lots are recorded as free text on the production record rather than as separate, individually searchable records.	Supplier and material detail is entered in the materials-used field of each run, and supplier records and certificates are held in Documents. One-step-back is evidenced from these together.
Orders placed before this system was introduced have no batch links.	Those orders are identifiable as untraced. The trace is complete from the date the system came into use.
A run recorded without a size cannot be added to stock automatically.	The system refuses and asks for the size to be supplied, rather than placing the quantity where it would later be lost.

Prepared for inspection by Environmental Health. Any record described here can be produced on screen or exported during a visit. Questions to Creamy Bite on +44 7497 779997 or orders@creamybite.com.